



“The availability of cheap Linux server solutions is helping fuel the growth of Linux in the Indian Web hosting industry.”

P Sridhar Reddy, MD and CEO, CtrlS

customers recognise it and feel a sense of trust. Because it is open source, there are always developments and new technologies becoming available. Linux has a strong ecosystem of development platforms, server components and applications that are very enticing to Web developers and site owners.”

Companies providing hosting solutions also prefer to work on Linux as it is compliant with a wide variety of hardware, affirms Reddy. “It is easier for independent developers to detect and fix errors on Linux, which means that problems can be resolved more rapidly. In theory, Linux has a good user-based technical support ecosystem, where users address their problems to the community, which invariably responds with fixes for problems,” he adds.

The flip side of Windows

The biggest disadvantage of using Windows as the Web hosting platform is that since it is not open source software, a user is forced to rely entirely upon the manufacturer (i.e., Microsoft) to release updates and provide bug fixes. Unfortunately, these bug fixes and updates may even take months to arrive, leaving the Web hosting providers and their customers high and dry. “Linux, on the other hand, is open source and hence developers and users can view and modify its source code. This makes it easier to spot bugs or potential problems and report them straight away,” emphasises Reddy.

On the technology front, both Windows and Linux operating systems have been coded by some of the most talented programmers in the world, and are extremely powerful. Reddy agrees and observes, “Linux has the LAMP stack for Web hosting while Windows has its IIS solution, both of which provide very capable software systems for hosting, uploading, and managing websites. The final choice may revolve around whether you specifically need a .NET framework and ASPX support, in which case Windows hosting would be the preferable solution. However, if you require a flexible, open-sourced solution, Linux hosting is your answer.”

Reasons that give open source Web-hosting solutions an edge

According to Reddy, the top five reasons why companies prefer hosting on a Linux based server, as opposed to a Windows based server, are as follows:

1. Licensing costs for Linux hosting solutions are lower than that for Windows hosting solutions.
2. The servers that implement Linux hosting solutions can support a higher websites-per-server ratio, without any compromise in the quality of service.
3. Linux hosting solutions are undoubtedly more stable than Windows.
4. Linux hosting solutions are known for their reliability.
5. Linux hosting servers are secure and fulfill client requirements efficiently.

Web hosting on the cloud

Many Web hosting companies these days are offering solutions on the cloud. The two key reasons why cloud-based hosting services are being increasingly adopted are the cost and the flexibility that the services provide.

So, does the cloud affect the regular hosting market? “It does in different ways,” says Andrade. “For the shared hosting market, [the cloud-based services] affect it in a transparent way. Customers who take advantage of a hosting company like Go Daddy will benefit from intrinsic scalability, resilience and security. Nevertheless, if they remain with old-school hosting providers using single hosting boxes, they will be stuck in the last decade,” he quips.

Reddy adds to this comment, “An increasing number of organisations are able to integrate performance and availability monitoring of cloud infrastructure services with the monitoring of the rest of their IT environments. This equips them to maximise the benefits, as well as the overall performance and availability of the cloud services they use.”

Though the concept of Web hosting on the ‘cloud’ has been relatively recent, Go Daddy claims it has been delivering solutions through the cloud for well over a decade, without actually referring to it as a ‘cloud’ service.